

How Live Pricing Works

How 25,000+ products reprice themselves every second — and why nobody on staff ever touches a price tag.

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THE ONE IDEA • IF YOU READ NOTHING ELSE

We do not set prices. We set markups — and the market sets the rest. Our catalog today holds 25,000+ fixed dollar amounts that go stale the moment gold moves. We are replacing every one of them with a small piece of arithmetic that runs the instant a customer looks at a product. Gold moves, and all 25,000 prices move with it, to the penny, with no one lifting a finger.

THE ANALOGY THAT MAKES IT CLICK

An airport currency booth doesn't reprint its board when the euro moves. It posts one rule — *"market rate, plus our cut"* — and the board redraws itself all day. **We are building that board for metal.** The rule is stored once; the number on screen is calculated fresh, every time, from live market data.

WHAT WE ARE REPLACING

Today a price is a number sitting in a file, written when the product was loaded. Gold rallies 3% and every gold item in the store is **underpriced by 3%** until someone notices. Gold drops 3% and we're above market and stop selling. Neither failure is visible until it has already cost us.

THE ENTIRE SYSTEM, IN ONE LINE

Price = (Live Market Price × Metal In The Coin) + Our Markup

Three inputs. The first changes every few seconds and we don't control it. The second is a fixed physical fact about the product. **The third is ours alone — and it is where 100% of our profit lives.**

1. The Three Inputs • Who Controls What

FOUNDATION

1 • LIVE MARKET PRICE

What an ounce of metal trades for right now on the world market. Arrives from a data feed, updates continuously.

Gold **\$2,400.00 / oz**
Silver **\$30.00 / oz**

Market controls

2 • METAL IN THE COIN

How much pure metal the physical item contains. A permanent fact — it never changes for a given product.

1 oz Buffalo **1.000 oz**
½ oz Eagle **0.500 oz**

Physics controls

3 • OUR MARKUP

What we add on top — sourcing, shipping, insurance, overhead and profit. Set by us, per product.

Standard gold **+5.5%**
100 oz silver bar **+\$1.80/oz**

We control • the business

2. One Product, Followed All The Way Through

THE MATH

American Gold Buffalo, 1 oz. Gold is trading at \$2,400. Our markup on standard gold is 5.5%.

METAL VALUE	+ OUR MARKUP	= PRICE SHOWN
\$2,400.00 \$2,400 × 1.000 oz	\$132.00 5.5% of metal value	\$2,532.00 Gross margin: \$132.00

Gold now rallies \$50 to \$2,450. Nobody is notified. Nobody edits anything. The next customer to load the page sees:

METAL VALUE	+ OUR MARKUP	= PRICE SHOWN
\$2,450.00 \$2,450 × 1.000 oz	\$134.75 Still 5.5% — scales automatically	\$2,584.75 Margin held. Zero human effort.

That is the whole system. Everything on the next two pages is about **controlling the markup** and **making sure it can never go wrong.**

The Dials and the Safety Nets

Four levers we can turn on demand — and three automatic guardrails that make mistakes structurally impossible.

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3. The Four Dials We Turn

COMMERCIAL LEVERS

A • MARKUP, BY PRODUCT

Change one number in the admin panel and every affected product reprices instantly — one product, a whole mint, or all gold at once. A promotion becomes a 10-second change, not a data project.

Gold Buffalo **+5.5%** • ½ oz Eagle **+7.5%**
Smaller coins carry higher markup — minting cost per ounce is higher.

B • VOLUME DISCOUNTS

Bulk buyers get a better price — but the discount comes **only out of our markup**, never out of the metal cost. The system cannot discount into a loss.

1-4 coins → +5.5% → **\$2,532.00**
5-19 coins → +4.5% → **\$2,508.00**
20+ coins → +3.5% → **\$2,484.00**

C • PAYMENT METHOD PRICING

Card processing costs us roughly 3%. Rather than absorb it on every sale, the price shown adjusts by payment method — the industry norm, and it steers customers to cheaper rails.

Crypto / USDC +0.0% → **\$2,532.00**
Bank wire / ACH +0.4% → **\$2,542.13**
Credit card +3.9% → **\$2,630.75**

D • BUYBACK PRICING

The same engine run in reverse quotes what we'll *pay* a customer for metal. The gap between our buy and sell price is a dial we set — and a second, independent profit line.

Customer sells 1 oz gold • market bid \$2,390
Less our 2.5% spread → we pay **\$2,330.25**

4. The Three Safety Nets

WHY THIS CAN'T GO WRONG

The obvious worry with automatic pricing is an automatic mistake. Three guardrails sit under every quote, and none depend on a person noticing anything.

GUARDRAIL	THE RISK IT REMOVES	HOW IT WORKS	IN PRACTICE
Margin Floor Always on	Selling below what we paid, after stacked discounts or a sharp market drop.	Every quote is checked against our acquisition cost. If it lands under the minimum margin, it is raised to the floor before display.	Cost \$2,470 Floor +1.5% → \$2,507.05 Never quotes below this.
Circuit Breaker Automatic	A glitched market feed printing an absurd price and draining inventory in minutes.	If the market appears to jump more than 3% in under a minute, or the feed goes quiet, quoting freezes and Ops is alerted.	The site shows an indicative price and pauses checkout rather than sell at a wrong number.
120-Second Lock Per order	The market moving against us between "Add to cart" and payment.	Clicking Buy freezes that exact price for two minutes, recorded on our server. Past two minutes it re-quotes.	Our exposure on any single order is two minutes of market movement — not two days.

5. What The Customer Actually Experiences

FRONT OF HOUSE

STEP 01

Browse

Every price is the live market price of that second. A spot ticker lets the customer verify our markup themselves.

STEP 02

Lock

"Buy Now" freezes the price for 120 seconds with a visible countdown, so the customer knows what they'll pay.

STEP 03

Pay

Crypto, wire or card — each showing its own price up front. No surprise fees on the last screen.

STEP 04

Allocate

Order confirms, metal is allocated to the vault, and net exposure is logged so it can be hedged.

What It Changes, and What We Need

The business case, the three inputs still needed from the company, and the questions that come up most.

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6. What Changes For The Business

THE CASE

MARGIN STOPS LEAKING

Every hour between a market move and a manual price edit is an hour we're either selling too cheap or not selling at all. That gap goes to zero, permanently, across all 25,000+ products.

HEADCOUNT DOESN'T SCALE WITH CATALOG

Adding 10,000 more products adds no pricing work. Today the catalog is only as current as the person maintaining it; after this, catalog size and staffing are unrelated.

MARGIN BECOMES VISIBLE

Because cost and markup are stored separately, we can see live gross margin per product, per category, per order. That reporting simply doesn't exist with fixed prices.

WE LOOK LIKE THE MAJORS

APMEX and JM Bullion both price this way. Buyers in this market compare premiums over spot, and a static price signals an amateur operation. This is table stakes for credibility.

7. Three Things We Need From The Company

OPEN ITEMS

INPUT	WHAT IT IS	WHY IT CAN'T BE GUESSED
1 · Market Data Feed Vendor decision	A paid subscription to a real-time gold, silver, platinum and palladium price feed. Typically a few hundred dollars a month.	This is the input the entire system runs on. A free or delayed feed means we quote stale prices.
2 · Our Cost Basis Blocking	What we actually pay our suppliers, per product or per category.	The margin floor is only as good as the cost number behind it. Without real costs, the safety net that stops us selling at a loss cannot be armed.
3 · The Markup Table Commercial call	Target markup by metal, by product family, plus the volume discount tiers.	A pricing-strategy decision, not an engineering one. It sets where we sit against APMEX and JM on every product.

8. Common Questions

STRAIGHT ANSWERS

Can the price change while a customer is shopping?

Yes, until they click Buy — exactly as it works at APMEX and JM Bullion. After that click the price is locked for 120 seconds and cannot move under them.

What if the market feed goes down?

Quoting freezes automatically and Ops is alerted. We show an indicative price and pause checkout. We never guess a price and never fall back to a stale one.

Can we still run sales and promo codes?

Yes — they come out of the markup, and the margin floor stops any stacked combination from cutting into cost. A discount can never produce a loss-making order.

Does this work for rare and collectible coins?

Differently, and deliberately. Collectibles carry a set collector price; metal value acts only as a floor beneath it, so a rare coin never sells for less than the gold inside it.

Will recalculating 25,000 prices slow the site down?

No. It is one multiplication and one addition per product as the page loads, with popular items briefly cached. It is faster than reading a stored price from disk.

Who can change a markup, and is it tracked?

Admin users only, through a controls panel with a live preview of the effect before publishing. Every change is logged with the user and timestamp.

THE BOTTOM LINE

We are replacing 25,000 numbers that go stale with **one rule that never does**. The market moves, our prices move with it, our margin holds — and the safety nets mean the system cannot sell below cost or act on bad data. The engineering work is scoped; what we need from the business is the cost data and the markup strategy.